

3.4 Unit 3, Topic B: Introducing Political Ideologies

Focus This topic introduces students to the subject of political ideology and examines the major ideas of liberalism, conservatism, socialism and anarchism.

What students need to learn: *Students taking Unit 3, Topic B must learn all areas within the topic.*

Liberalism

Key concepts	Content explanation
individualism freedom justice rationalism equality liberal democracy constitutionalism consent	■ A knowledge of core ideas, doctrines and theories of liberal ideology, particularly as they affect liberal views on human nature, the state, society and the economy. ■ An ability to discuss differing views and tensions within liberal ideology, notably between classical liberalism and modern liberalism.

Conservatism

Key concepts	Content explanation
tradition organic society hierarchy authority property paternalism libertarianism authoritarianism neoliberalism neoconservatism	■ A knowledge of core ideas, doctrines and theories of conservative ideology, particularly as they affect conservative views on human nature, the state, society and the economy. ■ A knowledge of differing views and tensions within conservative ideology, particularly related to divisions between traditional conservatism and the 'New Right'.

Socialism

Key concepts	Content explanation
co-operation fraternity collectivism social equality communism social democracy social justice third way	■ A knowledge of core ideas, doctrines and theories, particularly as they affect socialist views on human nature, the state, society and the economy. ■ An awareness of differences within socialism, in particular differences between revolutionary and evolutionary socialism and between fundamentalist and revisionism socialism. <i>(Questions will not be set on the features of 20th-century communism alone.)</i>

Anarchism

Key concepts	Content explanation
autonomy utopianism mutualism egoism anarcho-communism anarcho-capitalism anarcho-syndicalism	■ A knowledge of the core ideas, doctrines and theories of anarchist political thought. ■ An awareness of the breadth of anarchism, particularly of differences between collectivist anarchism and individualist anarchism, and of anarchism's relationship to socialism and liberalism. ■ A knowledge of the difficulties anarchists have faced in translating their goals into successful political practice.